SKILLSPRINT

VIDEO EDITING FOR BEGINNERS

From your first clips to your first finished video

LEVEL	DURATION	COST
Complete beginner	7 days	Free-tool approach

By The Starter Library

Learn one skill at a time. Practise a little every day. Build something you can share.

YOUR 7-DAY CHALLENGE

Create a 30-second video using your own footage. You will learn the basic editing workflow: import, arrange, trim, add text, use transitions, balance audio and export.

Welcome to SkillSprint

This workbook is designed for someone who has never edited a video before. You do not need expensive equipment, advanced skills or a paid course. A phone or computer and a few short video clips are enough to begin.

What you will learn

• Understand the basic parts of a video editor.

• Import clips and arrange them in a useful order.

• Trim unwanted footage and join clips together.

• Add a title and simple text.

• Use transitions without distracting the viewer.

• Add music and keep speech or important sounds clear.

• Make simple visual adjustments and export a finished video.

What you need

• A phone or laptop with enough free storage.

• Three to six short video clips that you recorded or have permission to use.

• Headphones if available (helpful, but not required).

• A video-editing app. Phone option: VN Video Editor. Laptop option: Shotcut. Availability and features can vary by device and region; use the official app store or official project website.

Choose one editing app and stay with it for this 7-day guide. The names and locations of buttons may differ between app versions, but the editing ideas are the same.

A few important terms

Term	Simple meaning
Timeline	The area where you arrange video, audio and text in order.
Clip	One piece of video or audio.
Trim	Shorten a clip by changing its start or end.
Split	Cut one clip into separate sections.
Transition	An effect that changes from one clip to another.
Export	Create the final video file so it can be watched or shared.

Day 1 – Meet your editing workspace

Goal: Open an editor, start a project and place three clips on the timeline.

Learn

Most editing apps have four main areas: a media area for your files, a preview window to watch the edit, a timeline to arrange clips, and tools for text, audio, effects and export. Do not worry about learning every button today.

Do it

1. Open VN on your phone or Shotcut on your laptop, or another editor you already know.

2. Create a new project. Choose a vertical format (9:16) if your goal is a Reel or Short; choose a horizontal format (16:9) for a regular YouTube video.

3. Import three short clips. Choose footage you recorded yourself or have permission to use.

4. Place the clips on the timeline in the order you want them to appear.

5. Press play and watch the sequence from beginning to end.

Practice task

Make a rough sequence of three clips. It does not need to look polished yet. Save the project.

Check your progress

■ I created a new project. ■ I imported three clips. ■ I placed them on the timeline. ■ I played the sequence.

Quick reflection: Which part of the editor was easiest to understand? Which part felt confusing?

My notes: _____

Day 2 – Cut, split and trim clips

Goal: Remove unnecessary parts and make a short sequence that flows.

Learn

Good editing is often about removing what the viewer does not need. Trimming changes the beginning or end of a clip. Splitting divides a clip into two pieces so you can remove a section from the middle.

Do it

1. Open yesterday's project.

2. Watch each clip and identify any long pauses, accidental footage or sections that do not help your video.

3. Use the trim handles to shorten the start or end of a clip.

4. If you need to remove a section from the middle, move the playhead to the start of that section and split the clip. Move to the end and split again. Select the unwanted middle piece and delete it.

5. Close any large gaps by moving the remaining clips together, if your editor does not do this automatically.

6. Play the sequence and check that the cuts make sense.

Practice task

Create a 15-second sequence from your footage. Aim for clear, useful moments rather than trying to include everything.

Common beginner mistake

Cutting too quickly can make a video hard to follow. Leave enough time for the viewer to understand what is happening.

Check your progress

■ I trimmed a clip. ■ I split a clip. ■ I removed an unwanted section. ■ I watched the whole edit.

Day 3 – Add titles and text

Goal: Add a clear opening title and one useful text label.

Learn

Text helps viewers understand the subject of a video. A title can introduce the video, while a short label can identify a place, activity or step. Keep text readable and avoid covering important parts of the footage.

Do it

1. Open your project and find the text or title tool.

2. Add a short opening title, such as “A Day Outdoors” or “My First Cooking Attempt”.

3. Choose a simple font and a colour that is easy to read against the footage.

4. Position the title where it does not cover the main subject.

5. Set how long the title stays on screen. A short title usually needs a few seconds to be read.

6. Add one more short label if it helps explain a clip.

7. Preview the video and check spelling, timing and readability.

Practice task

Add one opening title and one short label. Keep each phrase brief and easy to read.

Design tip

Use one or two fonts at most. Keep text style consistent throughout the video.

Check your progress

■ My title is readable. ■ Text does not cover the subject. ■ Spelling is correct. ■ Text timing feels right.

Day 4 – Use transitions with care

Goal: Make the change between clips feel smooth.

Learn

A transition controls how one clip changes into the next. A straight cut is often the clearest choice. A fade can work for an opening, ending or change in time. Too many animated transitions can distract from the video.

Do it

1. Open your sequence and find the point between two clips.

2. Preview the clips with a normal cut first.

3. If a transition would improve the change, choose a simple fade or dissolve.

4. Keep the transition short enough that the video does not feel slow.

5. Preview the edit. Remove the transition if it distracts or makes the sequence confusing.

6. Use a simple fade at the end if it suits your video.

Practice task

Try one transition between two clips. Compare it with a normal cut and choose the version that looks clearer.

Check your progress

■ I tested a normal cut. ■ I tried one simple transition. ■ I chose the clearer option.

Day 5 – Add music and balance audio

Goal: Add suitable audio without making speech or important sounds difficult to hear.

Learn

Audio is part of the story. Background music can set a mood, but it should not overpower speech or important sounds. Use music you created, music you have permission to use, or tracks provided under a licence that allows your intended use. Check the licence terms before publishing.

Do it

1. Choose an audio track that matches the mood and pace of your video.

2. Import it into the editor and place it on an audio track beneath the video.

3. Trim the music so it fits the video length.

4. Lower the music volume if it competes with speech or natural sounds.

5. Use a gentle fade-in or fade-out if your editor provides the option.

6. Listen with headphones if available, then listen through your device speaker as a second check.

Practice task

Add a music track and adjust its volume. If your video includes speech, make sure every spoken word is still understandable.

Audio check

■ Music fits the mood. ■ Music is not too loud. ■ Speech or important sounds are clear. ■ I have permission to use the audio.

Day 6 – Make simple visual adjustments

Goal: Make clips look consistent and check the overall flow.

Learn

Basic adjustments can improve brightness, contrast, colour and framing. Small changes are usually enough. The goal is to make the footage clear and natural, not to apply the strongest effect.

Do it

1. Watch your video from beginning to end without stopping.

2. Notice clips that look much darker, brighter or more colourful than the others.

3. Use basic brightness or exposure controls to improve visibility where needed.

4. Adjust contrast or saturation gently. Avoid making skin tones or colours look unnatural.

5. Check that the subject is visible and not accidentally cut off by the frame.

6. Watch the video again and remove any effect that makes the footage look worse.

Practice task

Make one or two small adjustments to improve clarity. Keep a natural look.

Final review checklist

■ The video has a clear beginning, middle and end. ■ Clips are in a sensible order. ■ Text is readable. ■ Audio is balanced. ■ No effect distracts from the content.

Day 7 – Your final 30-second video

Goal: Export a short, complete video and review what you learned.

Your project brief

Create a 30-second video about a simple subject: a hobby, a place you visited, a study routine, a small recipe or an everyday activity. Use footage you recorded yourself or have permission to use.

Build it

1. Choose the best clips and arrange them into a beginning, middle and ending.

2. Trim pauses and repeated moments.

3. Add a short title.

4. Use straight cuts or one or two simple transitions.

5. Add suitable music if you have permission to use it, and balance the volume.

6. Preview the entire video. Fix spelling, awkward cuts, empty gaps and audio problems.

7. Choose export settings that match your project. For a basic social video, 1080p is a practical target if your device supports it. Match the frame shape to the platform you intend to use.

8. Export the video and play the exported file to make sure it works.

Export checklist

■ Correct orientation and frame shape. ■ Video plays from start to finish. ■ Audio works. ■ Text is readable. ■ Exported file is saved in a folder I can find.

My project details

Video title: _____

What I did well: _____

One thing I want to improve: _____

Congratulations! You have completed the first SkillSprint video-editing challenge. Keep practising with new footage and try a different style next time.

7-Day Progress Tracker

Day	Task	Done	Notes
1	Create project and import clips	■	
2	Trim and split clips	■	
3	Add titles and text	■	
4	Test transitions	■	
5	Add and balance audio	■	
6	Make simple visual adjustments	■	
7	Export final 30-second video	■	

A few extra practice ideas

• Create a 15-second montage of three everyday moments.

• Make a short how-to video with three clear steps.

• Edit a before-and-after sequence using footage you are allowed to use.

• Create a silent version with captions, then compare how easy it is to follow.

Beginner editing glossary

Aspect ratio: The shape of the video frame, such as vertical 9:16 or horizontal 16:9.
Resolution: The amount of detail in the video, often described by dimensions such as 1920 × 1080.
Frame rate: How many still images are shown each second, often written as fps.
Fade: A gradual appearance or disappearance of video or audio.
Project file: The editable work saved by the editor; it is different from the exported video.

A note from The Starter Library

SkillSprint is a learning workbook, not a guarantee of professional results. App interfaces and features can change. Practise with your own files, save project backups, and check the usage rights for footage, music, fonts and other assets before publishing.

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